Classics at Colorado Symphony 2025





Journey with us through a host of magnificent symphonic works that you've come to know and love, reach new heights with elevated guest artists, and explore additional terrains with innovative and diverse programming.

TICKETS AVAILABLE FOR THE MARCH TO OCTOBER

VISIT WWW.COLORADOSYMPHONY.ORG FOR MORE

7-9 MARCH — Music of the Americas feat. Copland Symphony

Carlos Miguel Prieto, conductor. Colorado Symphony Chorus

Repetoire

CHÁVEZ Symphony No. 2, "Sinfonia india"
BERNSTEIN Chichester Psalms
CONTRERAS Corridos
COPLAND Symphony No. 3

Celebrate the music of the Americas with Bernstein, Copland, and Mexican composers Carlos Chávez and Salvador Contreras, all led by dynamic conductor Carlos Miguel Prieto. Chávez's Sinfonía india pulses with Mexican rhythms, syncopation, and vibrant instrumentation, while Bernstein's Chichester Psalms blends sacred texts with a touch of West Side Story, showcasing the Colorado Symphony Chorus. Copland's Third Symphony bridges his abstract and accessible styles, building from serene beginnings to a triumphant finale featuring Fanfare for the Common Man.

15-17 MARCH — The Four Seasons with Avi Avital

Carlos Miguel Prieto, conductor. Colorado Symphony Chorus

Repetoire

VIVALDI Concerto in D major, RV 93
BACH Concerto in A minor, BWV 1041
BACH Concerto in D minor for Violin and Oboe, BWV 1060
VIVALDI The Four Seasons, Op. 8

Baroque is at its best with this stirring program showcasing a perennial masterpiece: Vivaldi's The Four Seasons. A narrative piece that paints a portrait of Italy's expansive landscapes, mandolinist Avi Avital shows the versatility that this age-old warhorse maintains to this day. In a stunning performance not to be missed, Avital will shine on mandolin while simultaneously leading the ensemble

21-23 MARCH — Beethoven's Seventh Symphony with Peter Oundjian

Peter Oundjian, conductor. Peter Cooper, oboe

Repetoire

ROSSINI William Tell: Overture
HIDAS Concerto for Oboe & Orchestra
BEETHOVEN Symphony No. 7 in A major, Op. 92

Beethoven's Seventh Symphony has been dubbed the 'apotheosis of dance' due to the whirling, spinning motion at the heart of the composition. The iconic second movement "Allegretto" stands alone as a powerful, hauntingly beautiful, and relentlessly rhythmic piece of music that remains one of Beethoven's most beloved and well-known works. Your Colorado Symphony's own Principal Oboe Peter Cooper takes center stage on the delightful Hidas Concerto for Oboe & Orchestra while Rossini's Overture from William Tell highlights some of the most recognizable musical passages of all time, including the thunderous finale which is sure to have you on the edge of your seat.

4-6 APRIL — Carmina Burana with the Colorado Symphony Chorus

Ken-David Masur, conductor. Colorado Symphony Chorus, Duain Wolfe, director. Colorado Children's Chorale, Emily Crile, director

Repetoire

HAYDN Symphony No. 96 in D major, "The Miracle"
ORFF Carmina Burana

Conductor Ken-David Masur and your Colorado Symphony present Carl Orff's powerhouse Carmina Burana, a symphonic exploration of love, lust, and the perils of earthly pleasures. Featuring the Colorado Symphony Chorus, Colorado Children's Chorale, and a cast of soloists, Carmina Burana is a true spectacle and one of the most well-known pieces of the 20th century, combining powerful rhythms and robust vocals in a dynamicperformance you won't want to miss. Hear it alongside Haydn's Symphony No. 96, adding a counterpoint of symphonic bliss to a night of choralcataclysm.

25-27 APRIL — Tchaikovsky Piano Concerto No. 1 with Gabriela Montero

Peter Oundjian, conductor. Gabriela Montero, piano

Repetoire

TCHAIKOVSKY Piano Concerto No. 1 in B-flat minor, Op. 23
SHOSTAKOVICH Symphony No. 11 in G minor, Op. 103 "The Year 1905"

Pyotr Ilyich Tchaikovsky, renowned for his symphonies, cemented his legacy in piano music with his First Piano Concerto—brimming with lyrical melodies and Romantic spirit. Its iconic opening and fiery finale set the bar for virtuosos. Venezuelan pianist Gabriela Montero brings her dazzling technique to this classic. Shostakovich's Symphony No. 11, "The Year 1905" reflects the First Russian Revolution and the Bloody Sunday uprising. Living under an oppressive regime, Shostakovich mastered hidden expression, turning his music into a covert confessional. This symphony serves as a requiem for victims of war and injustice, conducted by Peter Oundjian.

2-4 MAY — Holst The Planets

Avi Avital, mandolin. Nicholas Tisherman, oboe. David Belkovski, harpsichord

Repertoire

VALERIE COLEMAN Fanfare for Uncommon Times
BRAHMS Schicksalslied, Op. 54 "Song of Destiny"
RAVEL La Valse, poeme choregraphique
HOLST The Planets

Holst's The Planets brings the solar system to life through seven distinct, astrological-inspired scores—from the relentless power of Mars to the haunting beauty of Saturn. Alongside this cosmic masterpiece, experience Brahms' Schicksalslied (Song of Destiny) with the Colorado Symphony Chorus, exploring the divide between gods and humanity. Ravel's La Valse and Valerie Coleman's Fanfare for Uncommon Times complete this dynamic program, led by guest conductor Eric Jacobsen.

16-18 MAY — Beethoven & Brahms with Christopher Dragon

Christopher Dragon, conductor.
Yumi Hwang-Williams, concertmaster.
Seoyoen Min, principal cello

Repetoire

RICE Dances in the Canebrakes
BRAHMS Concerto for Violin & Cello
BEETHOVEN Symphony No. 2 in D major, Op. 36

Celebrate rarely performed gems by two titanic icons: Ludwig van Beethoven and Johannes Brahms. Your Colorado Symphony's own Concertmaster Yumi Hwang-Williams and Principal Cello Seoyoen Min grace the stage with the mesmerizing interplay of the Brahms Concerto for Violin and Cello. Brahms, who spent much of his life coping with societal expectations of being the next Beethoven, capped an illustrious career with this never-before-seen double concerto pairing which often features violin and cello in dovetailing running scale lines, creating the effect of a single string instrument with a five- octave range. Beethoven's Second Symphony offers a glance to the past while looking ahead to the groundbreaking compositions to come that would usher in a new era of music. Set withinthe framework of Haydn's classical orchestra, audiences will hear Beethoven's new path taking shape, with subtle previews of the earth-shattering "Eroica" Symphony.

30-1 MAY/JUNE — Tchaikovsky Violin Concerto with Augustin Hadelich

Peter Oundjian, conductor. Augustin Hadelich, violin

Repertoire

HAYDN Symphony No. 96 in D major, "The Miracle"
ORFF Carmina Burana

Tchaikovsky—known for his lush, sweeping melodies for strings—surprisingly composed only one concerto for violin, but his lone installment overflows with a world of emotions. Principal Conductor Peter Oundjian and your ColoradoSymphony are joined by acclaimed GRAMMY® Award-winning violinist Augustin Hadelich in his much-anticipated return to Denver as featured soloist on Tchaikovsky's Violin Concerto — a piece initially considered so difficult to perform that the premiere was delayed after his first two soloists declined the invitation. Hadelich himself described the piece as one of the most exhausting concertos in the violin repertoire, both emotionally intense and physically demanding. Berlioz's Symphonie fantastique — a work epic in scale and ambition — requires tremendous forces and uses a recurrent melodic theme that ties the work together, surfacing in every scene of this epic and tragic journey. The composer's own self- destructive passions are on full display as he takes audiences through the gamut of human emotions, capping a season finale that is dramatic and stirring.

19-21 SEPT. — Respighi Pines of Rome with Peter Oundjian

Peter Oundjian, conductor. Pinchas Zukerman, violin

Repetoire

JOAN TOWER Suite from Concerto for Orchestra
BRUCH Violin Concerto No. 1 in G minor, Op. 26
— INTERMISSION —
BEETHOVEN Romance No. 2 in F major, Op. 50
RESPIGHI Pines of Rome

Peter Oundjian kicks off the season at Boettcher Concert Hall with a program reflecting his musical journey in his first concerts as Music Director. His longtime friend and mentor, Pinchas Zukerman, brings his masterful artistry to Bruch's Violin Concerto and Beethoven's Romance in F Major. Oundjian's collaboration with composer Joan Tower shines in a suite inspired by her Concerto for Orchestra, while Respighi's Pines of Rome closes the program with a breathtaking sonic portrait of the Eternal City—ensuring an unforgettable opening weekend.

3-5 OCT. — Tchaikovsky Symphony No. 4

Delyana Lazarova, conductor. Martin Helmchen, piano

Repetoire

UNSUK CHIN subito con forza
MOZART Piano Concerto No. 24 in C minor, K. 491
—INTERMISSION—
TCHAIKOVSKY Symphony No. 4 in F minor, Op. 36

Two auspicious debuts are sure to dazzle as Bulgarian-born Delyana Lazarova takes to the podium joined by one of today's most sought-after pianists in Martin Helmchen on Mozart's captivating Piano Concerto No. 24. A highlight among Mozart's two dozen beloved piano concertos, the piece projects a reflective, personal, almost intimate quality that will showcase the virtuosity of the prodigious Helmchen. The grand finale – Tchaikovsky's Fourth Symphony – is a meticulously paced reckoning with fate and one of Tchaikovsky's most enduring masterpieces. The piece was a turning point for Tchaikovsky on multiple levels: as a composer, toward mastery of technique; and as a human, toward confronting his darkest emotions. Over four movements, he transforms his battle with fate into one of humanity's most powerful works of art which electrifies in the hands of the dynamic Lazarova.

17-19 OCT. — Beethoven's Seventh Symphony with Peter Oundjian

Andrew Litton, conductor

Repetoire

MAHLER Symphony No. 9 in D major

Mahler's "farewell to the world" caps the career of one of history's most emotive and daring composers in a work brimming with blistering intensity, paralyzing terror, and tender nostalgia in equal measure before its trademark finale gradually gives way to calm repose. Never one to shy away from a grand musical endeavor, Andrew Litton has longed to take on Mahler's Ninth since his days as Music Director here in Colorado. During the genesis of the work, an ever-superstitious Mahler was keenly aware of the deaths of Beethoven, Schubert, and Anton Bruckner, all taken shortly after the completion of their respective ninth symphonies. He even went so far as to compose a "Tenth Symphony," Das Lied von der Erde, after his eighth in an effort to creatively avoid the same fate. In the end, Mahler too would succumb before he could hear a performance of this incredible meditation on mortality. Whether or not you believe in the "Curse of the Ninth," these performances will leave you with a deep sense of profundity and peace.

Robert Perez
Section 011 3:30-4:45
1000 14th Street, #15
Denver, CO 80202

Gunner Shepardson
1125 18th St
Boulder, CO 80309

2025 March-October season

Colorado Symphony